

CoinPicks Market Direction

Research Package

Five pillars — four researched narratives and one pure-math read of the Bitcoin chart — scored on one standard, blended into one table, and distilled to one number. Everything in this folder is current as of **August 22, 2026** — a catch-up cycle covering the Aug 16-22 gap (Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts were each researched but never delivered, and an Aug 21 session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers before stopping). **Today's score set is a DRAFT, awaiting my manual stamp — see the note below.**

➤ **Draft — flagged for manual review, not auto-stamped.** Three of four qualitative pillars held flat; Iran War Risk provisionally re-rated down at the front end on Iran's first vessel seizure since June (confirmed genuine) and a fatal Hormuz tanker strike this draft first mis-described as "the first confirmed fatality" in the campaign — a dedicated adversarial fact-check found that's false (roughly the 18th such death since late Feb 2026, a toll never previously scored by this report). Separately, the UAE missile-attack claim that drove the Aug 20 draft's "novel escalation vector" framing IS confirmed corrected: it remains single-source and was not actually the UAE's first direct hit (April/May incidents predate it). No window moved more than 8 points and no call-band flipped, but the fatality-framing error is a self-caught factual mistake, not just a disputed claim to weigh — it raises an open question about whether this pillar has under-scored the campaign's real severity for weeks, which shouldn't be self-approved same-cycle. See the Master Report's "My Decision" section for the full rationale.

THE FINAL NUMBER · AUGUST 22, 2026 (DRAFT) · BTC \$77,169.40

+0.70 Mild Bull — same call band as Aug 16, even though Iran War Risk re-rated down further and Bitcoin TA improved again

Equal-weight mean of the five window signals below — every pillar counts 20% (scale -10 to +10; horizon-weighted variant +1.22). Positive because the far windows outweigh the near ones — **not a buy-today signal**. It is a "the storm is priced, the recovery isn't" number. This cycle, two pillars moved for real and roughly offset: Iran War Risk fell further (provisionally — see warning above) while Bitcoin TA's computed pillar improved as BTC rose 7.4% to \$77,169.40. CLARITY, Tokenization, and Fed & Macro all held flat after four independent, parallel primary-source research passes.

THE FIVE WINDOWS UNDERNEATH IT

WINDOW	MASTER SIGNAL	CALL
1 month	-1.34	Mild Bear — unchanged call band; Iran's cut and TA's rally roughly cancel
3 months	-0.72	Mild Bear — the September FOMC still sits inside this window
6 months	+0.40	Neutral — CLARITY/Tokenization structural strength vs. Iran's drag
1 year	+2.06	Bull — all five pillars still positive
3 years	+3.07	Strong Bull — law + adoption + cycle + valuation

Bands: |s| < 0.5 Neutral · < 1.5 Mild · < 3 Bull/Bear · < 5 Strong · else Very Strong. The Mild Bull conclusion stays positive under every leave-one-out drop (+0.33 to +1.12); dropping CLARITY or Tokenization still rounds down to **Neutral**, unchanged from Aug 16. See the Master Report's Robustness section.

Reading order

Twenty minutes to the whole picture; each report stands alone and can be checked independently — every fact is dated with sources on its last page.

#	FILE	WHAT IT IS
1	CoinPicks_Master_Direction_Report.pdf	The summary. The final number, the five-window table, the full pillar matrix, where the lenses agree/fight, six weeks of dated triggers, sensitivity.
2	CoinPicks_Bitcoin_TA_Quant_Pillar_Report.pdf	The math pillar. 7 indicators on 16 years of data, halving-cycle analogs, power-law valuation — with charts. Fully reproducible from code.
3	reports/current/pdf/ — the four pillar PDFs	The story pillars. CLARITY Act · Iran War Risk · Tokenization RWA · Fed & Macro. Each: thesis, dated facts, honest bear case, dated triggers, and the full score lineage (June committed → Aug 16 committed → August 22 committed).
4	reports/archive/ + prior-work/	Every earlier version, preserved untouched — the score history is fully auditable.
—	run.py · engine/blend.py · data/master_blend.json	The blend engine (runnable Python — reproduce any score set with <code>run.py blend --set NAME</code>), its output, and README.md for regeneration.

How the scoring works — one paragraph

Every pillar answers the same question on five windows (1 month / 3 months / 6 months / 1 year / 3 years): **P** = the odds (0–100) that this force is *good for crypto* by then, **Quality** = how trustworthy the evidence is (0–1), and **Impact** = how hard this force moves the whole market (0–10). These combine into a **Signal** = $((P - 50) \div 50) \times \text{Quality} \times \text{Impact}$ (Impact is a uniform 8 for every pillar), so a coin-flip view scores zero no matter how loud the headlines are, and weak evidence can't shout. **All five pillars are equal-weighted** — the master for each window is the simple mean of the five signals (20% each; add a pillar and it auto-rebalances to 1/N) — and the Final Number averages the five master windows.

The five pillars at a glance (August 22 draft P's, pending stamp — Iran War Risk provisionally re-rated down further, three pillars held flat)

PILLAR	1MO	3MO	6MO	1YR	3YR	ONE-LINE READ
CLARITY Act (law)	32	47	58	82	92	Held flat: Sept 15 2:15pm ET cloture vote unchanged; Trump's Aug 19 White House push and the SEC's parallel rulemaking don't touch the ethics deadlock
Iran War Risk	14	22	38	54	76	Provisionally re-rated down further: Iran's first vessel seizure since June holds up; a fatal tanker strike's "first fatality" framing was found FALSE on adversarial check (~18th such death); UAE "novel escalation" framing corrected, not adopted
Tokenization (RWA)	52	60	66	74	85	Held flat: rwa.xyz total RWA value \$38.32B, tokenized Treasuries ~\$16.15-16.21B, both essentially flat; SEC rulemaking scoped to token fundraising, not RWA
Fed & Macro	43	41	48	56	62	Held flat: no new H.4.1/CPI/PPI in the window; CME FedWatch's September-hold odds (~69.4%) essentially flat vs. the ~65% already priced
Bitcoin TA (quant)	49	46	54	66	69	Quant pillar refreshed on today's price (BTC \$77,169.40, +7.4% vs. Aug 20) — weekly composite +26.1 (Slight bullish, 5-of-7), monthly Neutral

P values shown (50 = coin flip). Iran War Risk moved on real evidence; Bitcoin TA moved on the computed tape read; CLARITY, Tokenization, and Fed & Macro all held flat after four independent, parallel primary-source research passes.

Status & honesty notes

- **Score status:** August 22 scores — a catch-up cycle covering the Aug 16-22 gap (Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts were each researched but never delivered, and an Aug 21 session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers before stopping without finishing render/selfcheck/archive/commit) — are **LEFT AS A DRAFT, flagged prominently for Alex's manual review**, not auto-stamped. No pillar's P moved more than 8 points (largest: Iran -6 at 1mo) and no FINAL NUMBER call-band flipped, and the UAE "novel escalation vector" concern that withheld auto-stamp on Aug 20 is confirmed corrected — but a dedicated adversarial fact-check run this cycle found this draft's own "first confirmed fatality" claim (Iran War Risk) was FALSE, surfacing an open question about whether that pillar has under-scored a months-long tanker campaign's real severity. Per the runbook's own guidance to default to draft when verification surfaces an inconsistency that can't be fully resolved in an automated pass, this is left for a human. Every report prints the full lineage (June committed → Aug 16 committed → every draft through August 22, still awaiting stamp). Nothing hides its history — including its own mistakes.
- **Verification:** facts researched with primary/wire-source discipline via four independent, parallel research passes (one per qualitative pillar), THEN a dedicated adversarial fact-check on the two highest-stakes new claims — a step that caught a real error before delivery rather than after. This cycle's checks: the adversarial pass REFUTED the draft's "first confirmed fatality" claim (actual toll: ~18th seafarer death since late Feb 2026, a toll this report never previously surfaced) and CONFIRMED the UAE-attack-history correction (Iran-attributed barrages predate Aug 18); separately, this cycle pulled rwa.xyz's total RWA and Treasuries figures directly; read the SEC's Reg Crypto Assets proposal directly from sec.gov and confirmed its scope excludes RWA tokenization; pulled DOL/Fed primary releases directly for the Fed & Macro pillar.
- **Known limits, in print inside the reports:** cycle-analog claims rest on 3 completed cycles, a disclosed fragility this report has repeatedly flagged; the TA pillar caps its own conviction at $P = 50 \pm 25$; single-source items are labeled in-line (the UAE missile-attack claim remains single-source and is reported, not resolved); current chart bars are partial and the completed-bar numbers are printed; the Robustness section shows dropping CLARITY or Tokenization still lands at the Neutral/Mild-Bull boundary, unchanged from Aug 16.
- **The near-term calendar is the test:** next jobless claims and Fed H.4.1, both due Aug 27 · Fed Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole speech as Chair, Aug 28 · the first CLARITY cloture vote, precisely dated 2:15pm ET Sept 15 · an actual signed, operating Hormuz agreement the US accepts, or whether Bessent's promised sanctions package actually lands and how Iran responds · next FOMC (with SEP/dot plot), week of Sept 15 · GENIUS Act 18-month backstop effective Jan 18, 2027. Each pillar's trigger table says in advance what each outcome does to the scores.

This is research and education, not financial advice. The scores are probabilistic opinions with dated evidence — built to be argued with. If you check one thing manually, check the trigger tables: they are the falsifiable part.